



CATTLE AND DAIRY FARMING

Cattle are very popular domesticated animals because they provide us with a lot of food. They are kept for their meat, which is called beef, and also for their milk. Milk is full of calcium and protein, which makes it a very complete and nourishing food. Because of this, milk-giving animals are kept all over the world—but they are not always cows. Goats, sheep, camels, reindeer, and llamas give us milk, too!

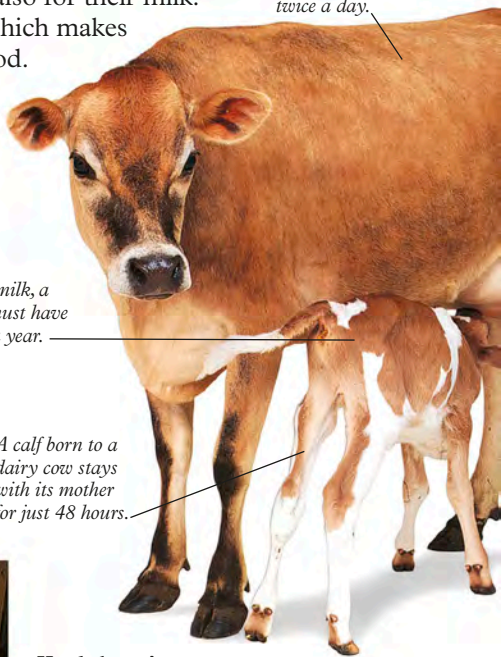
A cow gives milk for ten months of the year, then she rests for two months. Most cows are milked twice a day.

To produce milk, a dairy cow must have a calf once a year.

Milky ways

To make just two pounds (one kilogram) of butter, you need around six gallons (22 liters) of milk! The liquid that is left over is buttermilk.

A calf born to a dairy cow stays with its mother for just 48 hours.



Hard cheese!

Foods made from milk, such as butter, cheese, yogurt, and cream, are known as dairy products.

Making cheese is the best way to turn milk into a food that can be stored for some time. Thousands of different cheeses are made all over the world. Soft, creamy cheeses must be eaten promptly, but hard, crumbly cheeses will last for months and even years!

